Rings of Farmland

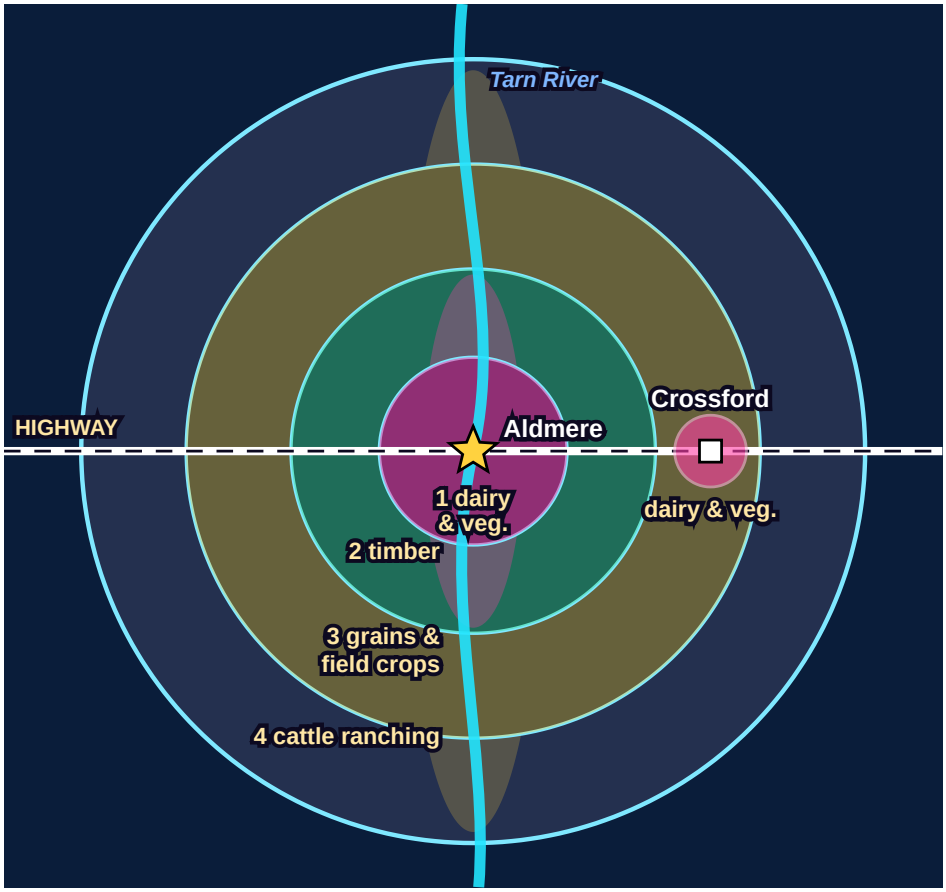
AP Human Geography · Unit 5 · One stimulus (like Question 2) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

Directions: Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

This diagram shows land use around a market city in a fictional farming region. Farmers sell their products in the city of Aldmere. A river flows through the region, and a highway crosses it from west to east.

Agricultural Land Use Around Aldmere, a Fictional Market City



1 Dairy & vegetables · 2 Timber / forest · 3 Grains & field crops · 4 Cattle ranching · River · Highway / town · Market city

Diagram created for practice. Aldmere, Crossford, and the Tarn River are fictional. Simplified and not to scale; lighter shading shows where a ring is stretched.

A. Identify the agricultural activity found in ring 1, the ring closest to the market city. IDENTIFY

B. Explain why the agricultural products grown closest to the market are the most perishable or the most expensive to transport. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

C. Using the diagram, describe how the river changes the pattern of land use compared with the classic von Thünen model. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

D. Explain how the secondary market town of Crossford along the highway shows how modern transportation changes the von Thünen model. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

E. Explain ONE way refrigerated trucking and global shipping have weakened the von Thünen pattern at the national or global scale. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

F. Describe ONE environmental consequence of intensive commercial agriculture in ring 1 or ring 3 of the diagram. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

G. Explain ONE limitation of using this model to understand agriculture in a less developed country today. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-